The Jester

Roguish Archetype Option

With a rustle of the bells atop his hat and a long bow at the waist, the gnome clad in a patchwork of colors introduces himself to a noble lord before breaking into a capering dance full of gesticulation and unrelenting noise. As the lord watches the gnome scuttle by, he opens his right hand to discover a note, penned in cryptic illusory script, informing him of the identity of a pair of assassins within his own court. The gnome issues him a knowing wink, and continues with his routine.

Flourishing his cape, a human clad in gilded finery collapses to the ground with a certain clownish lack of grace, clutching a nearly fatal wound in his side. By all appearances dead, the human waits, dagger drawn, for his enemy to slip up and leave themselves open to a savage injury to the ankles.

Spewing comical jibes and insults to dishearten her adversaries, a well-inebriated female dwarf cracks a kobold upside the head with the pommel of her rapier. Having recited a particularly bawdy limerick to utter silence from her captive audience, she wheels on the bludgeoned kobold and levels a stern glare in its direction. Instantly, the kobold descends into peals of mad laughter, and the dwarf juts out her chin, satisfied.

Comedy is an art form that some few study with an almost religious zeal, honing their words and their blades with endless practice and performance. Some that style themselves as jesters are simple entertainers with an adventurous bent, while others are genuine devotees of trickster deities such as Garl Glittergold, Avandra, or the Laughing God Who Has No Temples, and consider their jesting a holy calling of sorts. Regardless, a jester is a student of life, emotion, and culture, and appreciates both the highs and lows afforded to mortals by the conditions in which they live. A jester observes and comments, always knowing the right word or phrase to get a laugh, a tear, a bellow of murderous rage, or to simply swing the opinions of others their way.

Harlequin's Mask

When you choose this archetype at 3rd level, you gain proficiency with the disguise kit and two of the following: Dexterity (Acrobatics), Charisma (Performance), or one kind of gaming set.

You may, as an object interaction, either don a mask in your possession with traditional harlequin markings, or apply facepaint from your disguise kit to achieve a similar effect. In either case, while wearing your Harlequin's Mask you have advantage on any check to specifically cause a distraction or otherwise draw attention to yourself.

While wearing your mask, you may also cast the *vicious mockery* cantrip as a bonus action on your turn. When cast in this way, *vicious mockery* deals no damage.

Arcane Buffoonery

Starting at 3rd level, you gain the ability to cast a variety of spells as part of your jesting.

You learn the cantrips *vicious mockery, prestidigitation*, and *minor illusion*. You also learn three of the following spells: *Tasha's hideous laughter*, *illusory script*, *color spray*, *faerie fire*, *feather fall*, and *jump*.

You may cast the spells that you know from this feature once each per short or long rest, as if you had used a 1st level spell slot. If you choose to know the *jump* spell, it may only be cast with yourself as a target when using this feature.

Charisma is your spellcasting ability for any spell you receive from this archetype, and you use your Charisma modifier when setting the saving throw DC for a spell you cast with this archetype and when making an attack roll with a spell granted to you by this archetype.

Spell save DC = 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Charisma modifier

Spell attack modifier = your proficiency bonus + your Charisma modifier

These spells may only be cast or channelled while wearing your Harlequin's Mask.

Cruel Comedy

Starting at 9th level, your aptitude with the art of jesting gains more refinement, and your comedic barbs become ever more brutal and merciless.

Whenever an enemy fails its save against your *vicious mockery*, the first attack you make against that enemy before the end of your next turn has advantage.

In addition, while wearing your Harlequin's Mask you are immune to being charmed.

Jesting Magician

At 13th level, your repertoire of inherent magical knowledge expands to include several more mischevious tricks. You learn three of the following spells: *cloud of daggers*, *calm emotions*, *misty step*, *enthrall*, *mirror image*, *crown of madness*, *spider climb*, *feign death*, and *rope trick*.

You may cast the spells that you know from this feature once each per short or long rest, as if you had used a 2nd level spell slot. If you choose to know *feign death* or *spider climb*, they may only be cast with yourself as a target when using this feature.

In addition, the spells you have received from the Arcane Buffoonery feature may now be cast as if they were using 2nd level spell slots. Spells from either of these features may only be cast or channelled while wearing your Harlequin's Mask.

Last Trick

Starting at 17th level, when you are reduced to 0 hit points and are not killed outright, you can choose to drop to 1 hit point instead and place yourself under the effects of a false death identical to the *feign death* spell. On your turn you may end this effect as a bonus action. If you do, you have advantage on any attack targeting an enemy that believed you were dead, until the end of your next turn.

Once you use this ability, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Credits:

Photoshop & design by /u/the_singular_anyone

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Art by Simon Eckert, Nakai Wen, Neal Hanson, Taylor Fischer, and Levi Hopkins

Thanks to the kind folks of reddit, and to /u/skybug12 for his Photoshop guide!

Jesters & Multiclassing

Unlike their arcane trickster brethren, the jester carries with them no spell slots, and thus not even fractional caster levels.

When multiclassing as a jester, the levels you have taken as a rogue do not contribute to the spell slots you would receive from multiclassing, nor can you use spell slots to cast the spells you receive from jester archetype features.